

Glendeeep

Glendeeep's color is pale green; its crest is an arch.

Investigating the charge against: Crabtree and Evelyn

Companion: Gloucester (Steve Spodaryk)

Mission letter:

My good people,

As you well know, we lucky residents of Glendeeep have long enjoyed a peace and prosperity that many of our land-dwelling friends can only dream of. Perhaps that very peace has made us complacent, even careless.

Forgive me. My great worry has robbed me of my ability to speak clearly. Let me take you into my confidence and fully explain:

In the long-past days when Glendeeep sat on land like all the other Lyrian duchies, there was great inequity between those of noble and common birth. The noble families – mine very much included – lived in luxury in the great castles, while poorer families barely survived, left to eke out an existence farming the stony hillsides and often called upon to send their daughters and sons to fight and die in endless territory skirmishes.

Happily, recent generations have seen a much more equitable life for all of us. But not all the noble folk of Glendeeep consider these changes to be a positive development.

I have only recently learned that a small but powerful faction of noble families wish to return our duchy to a system of greater disparity between rich and poor. They want to reinstate brutally high taxes on commoners and to conscript those who cannot pay into a military force “to defend Glendeeep”, although presumably the only defense needed would be against those who oppose their oppressive rule.

Rest assured that I will defend a more equitable Glendeeep as long as there is breath in my body. But of course I will not live forever.

After hoping so long for a child, my wife and I have at last been blessed with the birth of a young son. It has been suggested that this faction might attempt violence against my boy, either to use him as a twisted sort of bargaining chip, or possibly to supplant my family altogether.

I am desperate to protect young Elijah, partially of course because of a father's great love, but also because I fear for Glendeeep's future. But I do not know exactly who among the other nobles may prove traitorous, and my wife and I cannot watch Elijah constantly and also govern.

I sought the counsel of my most trusted advisor, Glendeeep's High Priestess of Spring, asking how I might protect my sweet son. After much prayer on the subject, she relayed a dream she had, which is cryptic but perhaps presents a shred of hope.

The dream suggested that Elijah will be kept safe if we can use something called a “Ritual of Reclamation” to acquire the sword of Lorelei. I have never heard of anyone called Lorelei, nor do I know why her sword is special, but I have great faith in the High Priestess. According to her, the sword may be found in the duchy of Moreth, in a tiny village called World's Edge. In the hope that Glendeeep and my own sweet son may be kept safe, I ask you now to journey to that distant village. I have already sent a message to a gentleman named Leo North who I believe will be there at the same time you are. He is my tailor's wife's second-cousin and is said to be a good and kind soul. I have asked him to meet you when you arrive in World's Edge. I trust my message will arrive before you do, and that he will be expecting you.

I fear I can tell you little about the village to which you journey, save that it is tiny and provincial. It is the sort of place in which the old ways are still very much alive. Probably you will find it to be pastoral and rather dull. Regardless, there are of course dangers present on any journey. This is the case everywhere, but in Moreth – an area of unusually potent magical energy – it is especially true. Truly, there is no telling what you might encounter there. Protect yourselves and each other.

I realize that this journey will take you away during the upcoming festival of Harvest Home, and I thank you for agreeing to this mission. I apologize for sending you away from your families at this joyous time. Please believe that I would not ask this of you if time were not of the essence in this most critical matter.

On your quest, you shall no doubt encounter many of the citizens of World's Edge and may also meet travelers from other parts of Lyria. I am sure you know how important it is that you act as ambassadors of Glendeeep, leaving all you meet speaking well of our fair duchy.

The six of you have been carefully selected for this mission. Each one of you possesses unique skills that will prove invaluable during this quest; remember this when you encounter hardship along the way. I wish you much luck. I pray that the sword of Lorelei is indeed in World's Edge and that a Ritual of Reclamation can find it. May you be successful on your mission and return to aid our duchy as well as my own family.

With hope and gratitude,

Duke Galileo DelMar of Glendeeep

Contact: Leo North

Activity/Goals: introducing the party to the companion, getting comfortable interacting in the "otherworld"

Item: none

2nd Friday night encounter: Harrison Armstrong

Activity/Goals: getting comfortable interacting in the "otherworld"

Item: none

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3rd Friday night encounter: Evelyn

Activity/Goals: walking to their set location / experiencing combat

Item: none

Companion Note: before leaving the tavern, the 3rd Friday (or the Companion) should get the OK from the Friday Night Fight Coordinator. Also, the party should use the bathroom and have their gear stowed for walking.

4th Friday night encounter: Jonathan

Activity/Goals: perfectly good bucket challenge; practicing brainstorming, building on partymates' ideas

Item: paper listing the items the party will need to acquire (as well as the info about who to get them from)

Set Location: Crabtree & Evelyn's

Companion Note: the party must get the letter from the 4th Friday and write down the list of who to get all items from. At the end of this encounter, the Companion should let the party know that the scheduled portion of the evening is done. Individual participants can go to the cabin or return to the tavern as desired. They can walk around but can't visit other staffed set locations.

Paper listing the needed items/explaining how to use them:

C. – Here's that rite we were talking about. Can't think what you'd actually use it for, but of course there's plenty I don't know about. Best of luck to any poor sap who actually decides to try it, since the list of ritual components is a mile long.

Ritual of Reclamation (Seasons forbid anyone name these damn things something monosyllabic) Gather together:

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a rose-quartz orb

-

a revels cup

-

a brimstone egg

-

a viper's-eye pendant

-

a ghost key (whatever the hell that is)

a quantity of folly dust

-

devil's-fire whiskey (these old school ritual-writers were soused half the time, I think)

-

a spring tambourine

-

a shadow ward

As if acquiring all that wasn't already a big enough pain in the ass, the first step of the ritual is "place the shadow ward on someone and wait at least one year, and preferably five years or longer." So I hope the sap doing the ritual isn't in any sort of hurry.

Once you're ready to begin (if you haven't already died of old age) gather together seven people: the one who's got the shadow ward on, plus six others. None of them need to be keepers, though it doesn't hurt if they are.

Pour the devil's-fire into your revel's cup; have one person carry the cup. Have another one hold the rose-quartz, another the brimstone egg, another the ghost key, another the folly dust. Put the viper's-eye pendant on another. Give the tambourine to the person with the shadow ward.

Start your ritual in holy ground BUT (more pain in the ass) NOT the holy ground where you'll complete the ritual. Here in World's Edge, I'd choose Fern Grotto, for reasons that'll be clear in a minute.

All together, the seven people speak these words: "The bound shall be free. The weak shall be strong. The lost shall be found." Then they form a line with the ward-wearer first. She shakes the tambourine while the whole group walks to holy ground. (See, if you took my advice and started in the Grotto, you only have to listen to the damn tambourine while you walk to the Shrine of AllSeasons. You're welcome.)

No one but the ward-wearer may speak. As they enter the holy ground, she alone repeats the words: "The bound shall be free. The weak shall be strong. The lost shall be found."

And then presto, I guess, the ward-wearer can do... something? Find a lost thing, presumably? It better be something really great, if you've spent "preferably five years or longer" getting ready for the ritual. But hey, what do I know?

Anyway, give my best to E and J. – O.

Rationale: This is a note Obsidian wrote for Crabtree, detailing a ritual he's read about but never seen performed.

Keeper's Saturday morning dream:

The darkness of the dream swirls around you and then lightens and brightens to reveal a sun-dappled clearing. You hear the chatter of birds and the gossip of bees. The breeze blows soft in the summer air and the plants grown lush and green all around. In the Glen she stands, nature's bright-eyed daughter; her hair the dark gold of the burnished sun and her clothes the mossy sage of the thriving leaves. This is a place of death, but everything is lush and verdant and thriving around her.

In her right hand, she holds a knife. Her watchful eyes scan the foliage, knowing each stem and petal and frond by name, and when she finds the offending vine, she rips it roots and all from the earth. She is strong and unafraid of the phantoms that slumber beneath her feet.

The sun moves behind a cloud. And then you see her, a second girl, a mirror image of the first, her body stretching down and away into the grave-dark ground. Her skin is spectral white and her eyes are sunken and sightless. Her clothes are pale and ragged and her faded lips whisper haunted wraithlike promises.

In her left hand, she holds a key. It glints silver-frost in her skeletal fingers and the phantasmal wind blows.

The clouds are swept away and the sun shines bright and there is again just one girl, her eyes locked on yours and then the mists rise around her and you see no more.

Explanation: The vision shows the ghost key and will (hopefully) lead the party to Acadia Glen.

Companion Note: If the keeper doesn't read the dream aloud, the Companion should encourage them to do so.

1st Saturday morning encounter: Cade Wyatt

Activity/Goals: test of 10 challenge; acknowledging different areas of expertise within the party

Item: devil's-fire whiskey

Set Locations: meet party in tavern, bring them back to the mercenaries' camp in Greystone Clearing

Companion Note: Unrelated to the 1st Saturday encounter, the Companion should be thinking about which two people in the party would benefit from receiving a set of paired magic items. These are available from Septimus & Lavinia Quill.

Saturday unscheduled encounter: Bethany Bradford

Activity/Goals: what a surprise! challenge; creative problem-solving of open-ended problem

Item: rose-quartz orb

Times available (roughly): 8am-12pm, 2pm-5:30pm, 10:15pm-12am

Usually found: wandering

Saturday unscheduled encounter: Cassidy Adams

Activity/Goals: memorial challenge; develop party identity, articulate who they are & what they value, be creative

Item: none (she'll meet them at 9:30am in the tavern wearing the shadow ward)

Times available (roughly): 8am-11am, 1pm-7:15pm, 10:15pm-12am

Usually found: wandering

Saturday unscheduled encounter: Acadia Glen

Activity/Goals: what-tree-would-you-be? challenge; learning how others see you, being creative

Item: ghost key

Times available (roughly): 8am-2pm, 4pm-7pm, 10:15pm-12am

Usually found: at the Glens' house in Rosedale

Saturday unscheduled encounter: Trina Sunday

Activity/Goals: slippery slope challenge; working as a team

Item: revel's cup

Times available (roughly): 8am-2pm, 10:15pm-12am

Usually found: in the Trek Across Lyria camp

Saturday unscheduled encounter: Beck

Activity/Goals: combat teamwork challenge; becoming more comfortable with combat, working as a team

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Item: brimstone egg

Times available (roughly): 8am-3pm, 5pm-7:30pm, 10:15pm-12am

Usually found: at the Valerius house

Saturday unscheduled encounter: Natasha

Activity/Goals: BS! challenge; recounting fun adventures, being creative

Item: viper's-eye pendant

Times available (roughly): 8am-2pm, 10:15pm-12am

Usually found: in the Roamer Camp

Saturday unscheduled encounter: Kyli Talespinner

Activity/Goals: cup of insight challenge; learning about partymates

Item: spring tambourine

Times available (roughly): 10am-4pm

Usually found: in the Makai camp

Companion Note: The Companion participates in the cup of insight challenge along with the party. Unlike other encounters which can happen post-10pm if needed, the party must complete this challenge before 4pm Saturday.

Saturday unscheduled encounter: (mad) Cade Wyatt

Activity/Goals: mind of a madman challenge; working as a team, examining behaviors

Item: folly dust

Times available (roughly): 4-7pm (last entry at 6:45pm)

Usually found: Cade Wyatt will be in front of the tavern whenever he's available for this challenge

Endymion's TOTALLY OPTIONAL Riddle:

*Rosie Ro some things did know
Of roses pink or white as snow.*

*Sweet Rosie lived, that winsome dame,
In the place that matched her name.*

*Miss Rosie then did think to go
To see the jolly Roamers, oh!*

*And in her hand, a treasured sphere
So perfect-smooth, she held it dear.*

*She walked a bit, Miss Rose, alone,
But stopped before she reached the 'Rhone.*

*And there she paused, to drink a cup
Where the fog had long rose up.*

*Miss Rosie she was rarely daunted
But now she worried for she wanted*

*That precious thing kept safe, and so
Miss Rosie Ro, she crept below.*

*She hid it there, to safely store
It, 'mong the rocks, to roll no more.*

*Miss Rosie Ro, she stayed four score
But now, alas, she lives no more.*

*And silent-sleeps beneath the hill.
The treasure? Maybe sits there still.*

Goals: encouraging close observation of natural surroundings, practicing puzzle-solving

Location to which party is directed: among the rocks underneath Misty Bridge

Keeper's Sunday morning dream:

The mists of the dream swirl and then slowly clear. The forest rises dark around you. High on a branch, the nest sits precarious. In it, two birds sit, their grey feathers ruffled against the gossipy notes of the bitter wind. Two birds, but... no, three birds. You almost missed him there, a baby bird the same fawn-brown of the nest. He is held safe between the others, though he is not of their kind. You watch him, this foundling baby, and light falls tricksy-iridescent on him. His chestnut fluff is alight with subtle shimmer, bronze and copper and gold mixed in through the brown. How did you fail to notice him, this bright and special wee creature?

The wind increases. It worries and chides at the small nest. But have no fear, small one. The grey birds lift their wings, shielding him. He will be safe, protected, and if they are also accidentally trapping him here in the nest, they do not realize. The wind blows and blows and the mists rise once more around the nest and then you see no more.

Explanation: This vision shows Crabtree and Evelyn shielding Jonathan from outside cruelty... but maybe trapping him as well.

Companion Note: If the keeper doesn't read the dream aloud, the Companion should encourage them to do so.

Sunday morning penultimate step: meeting up with Cassidy Adams (wearing the Shadow Ward) who then accompanies the party

Scheduled for: 9:30am Sunday

Location: Cassidy will meet the party in the tavern and will then accompany them to their party path ending

Sunday morning final step: doing the Ritual of Reclamation (and, unbeknownst to them, animating the statue of St. Lorelei)

Scheduled for: 9:45am Sunday

Location: the ritual will be performed in Fern Grotto and then lead to the Shrine of AllSeasons